

$$A^2 \succeq B^2.$$

Symmetric square root: if $A \succeq 0$,

$$A^{1/2} = Q \operatorname{diag}(\sqrt{\lambda_i}) Q^T, \quad A^{1/2} A^{1/2} = A$$

For $A \succ 0$, $A^{-1/2}$ exists.

Ellipsoids (Lecture 15)

Quadratic representation: $c \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is the center; for $S = S^T \succ 0$,

$$\mathcal{E} = \{x : (x - c)^T S (x - c) \leq 1\}$$

If $Sq_i = \lambda_i q_i$, principal directions are q_i and semiaxis lengths are $1/\sqrt{\lambda_i}$. Large λ_i means a short, thin direction. Boundary parametrization:

$$x = c + Q \Lambda^{-1/2} u, \quad \|u\| = 1$$

$S \succ 0$ means all $\lambda_i > 0$, so S^{-1} exists and the set is bounded. Singular $S \succeq 0$ instead gives an unbounded elliptical cylinder along $\operatorname{null}(S)$. The longest-to-shortest semiaxis ratio is $\sqrt{\lambda_{\max}(S)/\lambda_{\min}(S)}$.

Scaled / covariance ellipsoid:

$$(x - c)^T \Sigma^{-1} (x - c) \leq \alpha$$

has semiaxis lengths $\sqrt{\alpha \lambda_i(\Sigma)}$. Multiplying α by four doubles all lengths.

Image-of-ball representation:

$$\mathcal{E} = \{c + Bz : \|z\| \leq 1\}, \quad B \text{ invertible}$$

is equivalent to $S = (BB^T)^{-1}$. Given S , all valid maps are

$$B = S^{-1/2} R, \quad R \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}, \quad R^T R = I$$

R is any rotation or reflection of the unit ball, explaining why the quadratic matrix S is unique while B is not. The left singular vectors of B give the ellipsoid axes and $\sigma_i(B)$ give their semiaxis lengths. Also

$$\operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{E}) = \operatorname{vol}(\mathbb{B}_n) |\det B| = \frac{\operatorname{vol}(\mathbb{B}_n)}{\sqrt{\det S}}$$

Under an invertible affine map $y = Mx + d$, the center and quadratic matrix transform as

$$c_y = Mc + d, \quad S_y = M^{-T} S M^{-1}$$

Sensors: if $y = B^T x$, then

$$\|y\|^2 \leq 1 \iff x^T B B^T x \leq 1$$

This is a bounded ellipsoid iff $B B^T \succ 0$, i.e. the sensor vectors span the state space.

Fitting an ellipsoid: $x_k^T S x_k \approx 1$ is linear in the unique symmetric entries of S . A design row contains x_i^2 on diagonal terms and $2x_i x_j$ on off-diagonal terms. Solve $\Phi \theta \approx 1$

then reconstruct S , verify $S \succ 0$, and assess $(x_k^T S x_k - 1)$ using RMS and maximum absolute error.

Matrix Norm and Gain (Lecture 16)

Maximum gain / induced 2-norm:

$$\|A\| = \max_{x \neq 0} \frac{\|Ax\|_2}{\|x\|_2} = \max_{\|x\|_2=1} \|Ax\|_2, \\ \|A\| = \sqrt{\lambda_{\max}(A^T A)} = \sigma_{\max}(A)$$

The maximizing input is the top eigenvector of $A^T A$; its output direction is the corresponding left singular vector.

$$\|A\| = \max_{\|u\|=\|v\|=1} |u^T A v|$$

Consequently every entry, row norm, and column norm is at most $\|A\|$: $|A_{ij}| \leq \|A\|$, $\|A^T e_i\| \leq \|A\|$, $\|A e_j\| \leq \|A\|$.

Minimum gain:

$$\sigma_{\min}(A) = \min_{\|x\|=1} \|Ax\| = \sqrt{\lambda_{\min}(A^T A)}$$

It is zero iff $\operatorname{null}(A) \neq \{0\}$. For a square invertible matrix it is the smallest singular value and $\|A^{-1}\| = 1/\sigma_{\min}(A)$. Equality in the maximum/minimum gain bounds occurs at the corresponding right singular vectors.

Gain bounds / norm properties: for $x \neq 0$,

$$\sigma_{\min}(A) \leq \frac{\|Ax\|}{\|x\|} \leq \sigma_{\max}(A) = \|A\|,$$

$$\|AB\| \leq \|A\| \|B\|, \quad \|A^T\| = \|A\|, \\ \|\alpha A\| = |\alpha| \|A\|, \quad \|A + B\| \leq \|A\| + \|B\|$$

For square X, Y ,

$$\sigma_{\max}(XY) \leq \sigma_{\max}(X) \sigma_{\max}(Y), \\ \sigma_{\min}(XY) \geq \sigma_{\min}(X) \sigma_{\min}(Y), \\ \sigma_{\min}(X + Y) \geq \sigma_{\min}(X) - \sigma_{\max}(Y)$$

Frobenius norm:

$$\|A\|_F = \sqrt{\sum_{ij} A_{ij}^2} = \sqrt{\operatorname{tr}(A^T A)} = \sqrt{\sum_i \sigma_i^2}$$

It is the Euclidean norm of all entries, not the maximum gain.

$$\|A\| \leq \|A\|_F \leq \sqrt{\operatorname{rank}(A)} \|A\|$$

Norm invertibility test: $\|E\| < 1$ implies

$$(I - E)^{-1} = \sum_{k \geq 0} E^k, \quad \|(I - E)^{-1}\| \leq (1 - \|E\|)^{-1}$$

Thus $A + \Delta A$ is invertible if $\|A^{-1} \Delta A\| < 1$.

SVD (Lecture 17)

Thin SVD: every real matrix has an SVD. If $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$

has rank r ,

$$A = U_r \Sigma_r V_r^T = \sum_{i=1}^r \sigma_i u_i v_i^T$$

$$U_r \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times r}, \quad V_r \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times r},$$

$$\Sigma_r = \operatorname{diag}(\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r), \quad \sigma_1 \geq \dots \geq \sigma_r > 0$$

Columns of U_r, V_r are orthonormal, and

$$A v_i = \sigma_i u_i, \quad A^T u_i = \sigma_i v_i$$

For any input,

$$Ax = \sum_{i=1}^r \sigma_i (v_i^T x) u_i$$

Thus v_i is an input direction, u_i its output direction, and σ_i its gain. The unit ball maps to an ellipsoid with semiaxes $\sigma_i u_i$; right-nullspace directions collapse to zero.

$$\|Ax\|^2 = \sum_{i=1}^r \sigma_i^2 (v_i^T x)^2$$

How to construct / recognize it:

$$A^T A v_i = \sigma_i^2 v_i, \quad u_i = \frac{A v_i}{\sigma_i} \quad (\sigma_i > 0)$$

Thus SVD comes from the symmetric EVD of $A^T A$, but avoids squaring the matrix numerically in actual computation. Orthogonal changes of basis do not change singular values: $\sigma_i(Q_1 A Q_2) = \sigma_i(A)$.

SVD and four spaces:

$$\begin{array}{l|l} \operatorname{range}(A) & \operatorname{span}\{u_1, \dots, u_r\} \\ \operatorname{range}(A^T) & \operatorname{span}\{v_1, \dots, v_r\} \\ \operatorname{null}(A^T) & \operatorname{span}\{\text{remaining left } u_i\} \\ \operatorname{null}(A) & \operatorname{span}\{\text{remaining right } v_i\} \end{array}$$

$A^T A = V_r \Sigma_r^2 V_r^T$ and $AA^T = U_r \Sigma_r^2 U_r^T$: nonzero eigenvalues are σ_i^2 .

Full SVD:

$$A = U \Sigma V^T, \quad U \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times m}, \quad V \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$$

with orthogonal U, V and rectangular diagonal Σ , whose first r entries are positive and the rest zero. It means: rotate by V^T , scale/truncate/zero-pad by Σ , then rotate by U .

$$\operatorname{rank}(A) = \#\{\sigma_i > 0\}, \quad \|A\| = \sigma_1, \quad \|A\|_F^2 = \sum_i \sigma_i^2$$

For square A , $|\det A| = \prod_i \sigma_i$. Tall full-column-rank means $r = n$, every input direction has positive gain, and A is one-to-one. Wide full-row-rank means $r = m$, every output is attainable, but $n - m$ input directions lie in $\operatorname{null}(A)$.

Symmetric case: if $A = A^T$, its singular values are the absolute eigenvalues, sorted by magnitude:

$$\{\sigma_i(A)\} = \{|\lambda_i(A)|\}$$

For $\lambda_i \neq 0$, one choice is $v_i = q_i$, $u_i = \operatorname{sign}(\lambda_i) q_i$.

EVD versus SVD: EVD applies to square A , can require complex vectors, and can fail to diagonalize; it maps each eigenvector back onto itself with signed/complex factor λ_i . SVD always exists, uses orthonormal input/output bases, and has nonnegative gains σ_i . For symmetric $A \succeq 0$, they coincide: $U = V = Q$, $\Sigma = \Lambda$.

Moore–Penrose pseudoinverse:

$$A^\dagger = V_r \Sigma_r^{-1} U_r^T$$

Special cases:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{full column rank: } A^\dagger &= (A^T A)^{-1} A^T, \\ \text{full row rank: } A^\dagger &= A^T (A A^T)^{-1}, \\ \text{invertible: } A^\dagger &= A^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

For every A, y , $A^\dagger y$ is the minimum-norm vector among all least-squares minimizers. All LS minimizers are

$$x = A^\dagger y + z, \quad z \in \operatorname{null}(A)$$

The four identities are

$$\begin{aligned} A A^\dagger A &= A, & A^\dagger A A^\dagger &= A^\dagger, \\ (A A^\dagger)^T &= A A^\dagger, & (A^\dagger A)^T &= A^\dagger A \end{aligned}$$

Thus

$$A A^\dagger = P_{\operatorname{range}(A)}, \quad A^\dagger A = P_{\operatorname{range}(A^T)}$$

and $I - A A^\dagger = P_{\operatorname{null}(A^T)}$, $I - A^\dagger A = P_{\operatorname{null}(A)}$.

Regularization limit / filters:

$$A^\dagger = \lim_{\mu \downarrow 0} (A^T A + \mu I)^{-1} A^T$$

in the action on data. In singular coordinates,

$$x_\mu = \sum_{i=1}^r \frac{\sigma_i}{\sigma_i^2 + \mu} (u_i^T y) v_i$$

Ordinary LS uses gain $1/\sigma_i$; Tikhonov multiplies it by $\sigma_i^2/(\sigma_i^2 + \mu)$, strongly damping small- σ_i directions.

Sensitivity / condition number: on the nonzero singular spectrum, $\kappa = \sigma_1/\sigma_r$; rank deficiency gives $\kappa = \infty$. For invertible A ,

$$\kappa(A) = \|A\| \|A^{-1}\| = \frac{\sigma_{\max}}{\sigma_{\min}} \geq 1$$

If $Ax = y$ and only y is perturbed,

$$\frac{\|\delta x\|}{\|x\|} \leq \kappa(A) \frac{\|\delta y\|}{\|y\|}$$

A small $\sigma_{\min}$ means large noise amplification and proximity to singularity. The bound is worst-case and is attained by aligned singular directions; roughly $\log_{10} \kappa$ decimal digits can be lost.

Best low-rank approximation: truncate after $k < r$:

$$A_k = \sum_{i=1}^k \sigma_i u_i v_i^T$$

Eckart–Young:

$$\min_{\operatorname{rank}(B) \leq k} \|A - B\| = \sigma_{k+1},$$

$$\min_{\operatorname{rank}(B) \leq k} \|A - B\|_F = \sqrt{\sum_{i>k} \sigma_i^2}$$

σ_r is the operator-norm distance to $\operatorname{rank} < r$; for invertible square A , $\sigma_{\min}$ is distance to singularity. Singular values below the modeling/noise scale are not reliably distinguishable from zero; retaining only values above that floor gives an effective rank and a simpler model.

Truncated-SVD inverse:

$$x_{\text{TSVD}}^{(k)} = \sum_{i=1}^k \frac{u_i^T y}{\sigma_i} v_i$$

Small k causes bias/oversmoothing; large k admits noise-amplifying directions. Choose k by the error/validation tradeoff, not just numerical rank.

PCA (Lecture 18)

Center first: with data as columns $X = [x_1 \dots x_N]$,

$$\bar{x} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_i x_i, \quad X_c = [x_1 - \bar{x} \dots x_N - \bar{x}],$$

$$S = \frac{1}{N} X_c X_c^T$$

$S = S^T \succeq 0$. If data are stored as rows, use $S = X_c^T X_c / N$ and transpose the singular-vector roles. Since centered columns sum to zero, $\operatorname{rank}(X_c) \leq \min(n, N - 1)$. Without centering, the first component can mostly describe the mean rather than variation.

Variance direction: for unit v ,

$$\operatorname{var}(v^T x_i) = v^T S v$$

This is maximized by the top eigenvector u_1 of S , with value λ_1 . Subsequent PCs maximize variance subject to orthogonality. The coordinate $u_j^T (x_i - \bar{x})$ is the score of sample i on component j . Total variance is split among the PCs:

$$\operatorname{tr}(S) = \sum_i \lambda_i = \frac{1}{N} \|X_c\|_F^2$$

SVD connection: if $X_c = U \Sigma V^T$, then

$$S = U \frac{\Sigma \Sigma^T}{N} U^T, \quad \lambda_i = \frac{\sigma_i^2}{N}$$

For column-stored data the principal directions are left singular vectors u_i .

Projection / reconstruction: with $U_k = [u_1 \dots u_k]$,

$$z_i = U_k^T (x_i - \bar{x}), \quad \hat{x}_i = \bar{x} + U_k z_i$$

In matrix form,

$$Z = U_k^T X_c = \Sigma_k V_k^T, \quad \hat{X}_c = U_k Z = U_k U_k^T X_c$$

The score coordinates are centered and mutually uncorrelated:

$$\frac{1}{N} Z Z^T = \operatorname{diag}(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_k)$$

The optimal k -dimensional affine subspace passes through $\bar{x}$ and uses the top PCs. Its mean-square reconstruction error is

$$E_k = \frac{1}{N} \sum_i \|x_i - \hat{x}_i\|^2 = \sum_{i>k} \lambda_i = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i>k} \sigma_i^2$$

Fraction of variance captured:

$$\rho_k = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^k \lambda_i}{\sum_i \lambda_i} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^k \sigma_i^2}{\sum_i \sigma_i^2}$$

Pythagoras gives, sample by sample,

$$\|x_c\|^2 = \|U_k U_k^T x_c\|^2 + \|(I - U_k U_k^T) x_c\|^2$$

so maximizing captured variance and minimizing perpendicular reconstruction error are the same problem. Equivalently, $\hat{X}_c = U_k \Sigma_k V_k^T$ is the best rank- k approximation. Reconstruction is exact once $k \geq \operatorname{rank}(X_c)$.

Choosing / interpreting k : use a target ρ_k , a screeplot elbow or spectral gap, and preferably validation for downstream error. Standardize coordinates first when incompatible units/scales should have equal importance; PCA itself is not scale invariant. PC signs are arbitrary. With repeated eigenvalues, the principal subspace is determined but an individual orthonormal basis inside it is not.

Covariance ellipsoid / whitening: for $S \succ 0$,

$$(x - \bar{x})^T S^{-1} (x - \bar{x}) \leq \alpha$$

has axes u_i and lengths $\sqrt{\alpha \lambda_i}$. The whitened coordinate $z = S^{-1/2} (x - \bar{x})$ has identity covariance, and

$$\sqrt{(x - \bar{x})^T S^{-1} (x - \bar{x})} = \|z\|$$

is Mahalanobis distance: distance from the mean measured in standard deviations rather than raw units.

Small singular values: for $Y = [y_1 \dots y_N] \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times N}$, $N \geq m$,

$$\min_{\|q\|=1} \frac{q^T Y}{\|Y\|_F} = \frac{\sigma_{\min}(Y)}{\|Y\|_F}$$

The minimizing q is the bottom left singular vector; a

small value reveals $q^T y_i \approx 0$. Center for affine relations. Spectral gaps above the noise floor reveal effective dimension/source count.

Projection–EVD–SVD–PCA Connections

One recurring operation: resolve into coordinates, weight selected coordinates, then reconstitute:

orthogonal projection	$P_S x = \sum_i (u_i^T x) u_i$
symmetric EVD	$A x = \sum_i \lambda_i (q_i^T x) q_i$
SVD	$A x = \sum_i \sigma_i (v_i^T x) u_i$
PCA reconstruction	$\hat{x} = \bar{x} + \sum_{i=1}^k u_i u_i^T (x - \bar{x})$

A projector is a symmetric matrix whose EVD has only 0's and 1's. Symmetric EVD permits signed weights λ_i ; SVD uses nonnegative gains and different input/output directions. PCA applies symmetric EVD to covariance, equivalently SVD to centered data, then keeps the high-variance projectors.

Which target is closest?

- LS output target $y : AA^\dagger y$
- least-norm target $0 : A^\dagger y$
- PCA centered target $x - \bar{x} : U_k U_k^T (x - \bar{x})$

Always identify the ambient space first: $AA^\dagger \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times m}$ projects outputs, while $A^\dagger A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ projects inputs.

Homework 6–7 Patterns

Ellipsoid fitting check: positivity of the fitted eigenvalues proves the quadratic surface is a bounded ellipsoid. Mean residual near zero can hide cancellation; report RMS $\|r - 1\|/\sqrt{N}$ and $\|r - 1\|_\infty$.

Singular-value proof tools: for the square matrices in HW7, use

$$\sigma_{\max}(A) = \max_{\|x\|=1} \|Ax\|, \quad \sigma_{\min}(A) = \min_{\|x\|=1} \|Ax\|$$

then apply ordinary/reverse triangle inequalities. A row norm is $\|A^T e_i\| \leq \sigma_{\max}(A)$; no analogous lower bound holds for every row.

Deconvolution: smoothing operators have smooth, low-frequency right singular vectors at large σ_i , while high-frequency directions often have tiny σ_i . Direct inversion amplifies noise. TSVD discards those directions; Tikhonov damps them continuously.

Tikhonov estimator as a matrix: for

$$B_\mu = (A^T A + \mu I)^{-1} A^T$$

its singular-direction gains are

$$g_i = \frac{\sigma_i}{\sigma_i^2 + \mu}, \quad \|B_\mu\| = \max_i g_i$$

The g_i need not remain sorted in the order of σ_i . Also

$$AB_\mu - I = -U \operatorname{diag} \left(\frac{\mu}{\sigma_i^2 + \mu} \right) U^T$$

for square full SVD, so worst reconstruction bias is governed by the smallest singular value.

Probability Basics (Lecture 19)

Events / axioms: sample space Ω , outcome $\omega \in \Omega$, event $A \subseteq \Omega$. Probability satisfies

$$\mathbb{P}(A) \geq 0, \quad \mathbb{P}(\Omega) = 1, \quad \mathbb{P}(A \cup B) = \mathbb{P}(A) + \mathbb{P}(B)$$

for disjoint A, B . Hence

$$\mathbb{P}(A^c) = 1 - \mathbb{P}(A), \quad \mathbb{P}(A \cup B) = \mathbb{P}(A) + \mathbb{P}(B) - \mathbb{P}(A \cap B)$$

Conditioning / Bayes:

$$\mathbb{P}(A | B) = \frac{\mathbb{P}(A \cap B)}{\mathbb{P}(B)}, \quad \mathbb{P}(A | B) = \frac{\mathbb{P}(B | A) \mathbb{P}(A)}{\mathbb{P}(B)}$$

A, B are independent iff $\mathbb{P}(A \cap B) = \mathbb{P}(A) \mathbb{P}(B)$, equivalently $\mathbb{P}(A | B) = \mathbb{P}(A)$. For a disjoint exhaustive partition $\{A_i\}$,

$$\mathbb{P}(B) = \sum_i \mathbb{P}(B | A_i) \mathbb{P}(A_i)$$

Distributions: discrete PMF $p(x) = \mathbb{P}(X = x)$, $\sum_x p(x) = 1$. Continuous PDF $f(x) \geq 0$,

$$\mathbb{P}(a \leq X \leq b) = \int_a^b f(x) dx, \quad \int f = 1$$

CDF $F(t) = \mathbb{P}(X \leq t)$ works in both cases; for a continuous variable, $F'(t) = f(t)$ where differentiable. For a joint density $f_{X,Y}$, marginalize via $f_X(y) = \int f_{X,Y}(x, y) dy$, and $f_{X|Y}(x | y) = f_{X,Y}(x, y) / f_Y(y)$.

Common distributions:

X	$\mathbb{E}X$	$\operatorname{var} X$
Bern(p)	p	$p(1 - p)$
Bin(n, p)	np	$np(1 - p)$
Unif($[a, b]$)	$(a + b)/2$	$(b - a)^2/12$
Exp(λ)	$1/\lambda$	$1/\lambda^2$
$\mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$	μ	σ^2

Also Poisson(λ) has mean and variance λ .

Expectation / moments:

$$\mathbb{E}[g(X)] = \sum_x g(x) p(x) \quad \text{or} \quad \int g(x) f(x) dx$$

$\mathbb{E}[aX + bY + c] = a\mathbb{E}X + b\mathbb{E}Y + c$
Linearity never requires independence. The k th moment is $\mathbb{E}X^k$; the k th central moment is $\mathbb{E}[(X - \mathbb{E}X)^k]$. Tower property: $\mathbb{E}X = \mathbb{E}[\mathbb{E}X | Y]$.

Variance:

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{var} X &= \mathbb{E}[(X - \mu)^2] = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - \mu^2, \\ \operatorname{var}(aX + b) &= a^2 \operatorname{var} X \\ \operatorname{var}(X + Y) &= \operatorname{var} X + \operatorname{var} Y + 2 \operatorname{Cov}(X, Y) \end{aligned}$$

For independent variables the covariance term is zero.

Law of total variance:

$$\operatorname{var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[\operatorname{var}(X | Y)] + \operatorname{var}(\mathbb{E}[X | Y])$$

Covariance / correlation:

$$\operatorname{Cov}(X, Y) = \mathbb{E}[(X - \mu_X)(Y - \mu_Y)] = \mathbb{E}[XY] - \mu_X \mu_Y$$

$$\rho_{XY} = \frac{\operatorname{Cov}(X, Y)}{\sigma_X \sigma_Y} \in [-1, 1]$$

Independence implies zero covariance; zero covariance generally does not imply independence.

Random vectors: for $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$,

$$\mu = \mathbb{E}x, \quad \Sigma = \operatorname{Cov}(x) = \mathbb{E}[(x - \mu)(x - \mu)^T] \succeq 0$$

Diagonal entries are variances; off-diagonal entries are covariances. For every deterministic a ,

$$a^T \Sigma a = \operatorname{var}(a^T x) \geq 0$$

which proves $\Sigma \succeq 0$ and links covariance eigenvectors to PCA. For deterministic A, b ,

$$\mathbb{E}[Ax + b] = A\mu + b, \quad \operatorname{Cov}(Ax + b) = A\Sigma A^T$$

For cross-covariance $\Sigma_{xy} = \mathbb{E}[(x - \mu_x)(y - \mu_y)^T]$, $\operatorname{Cov}(Ax, By) = A\Sigma_{xy}B^T$. If independent x, w , then $\operatorname{Cov}(Ax + w) = A\Sigma_x A^T + \Sigma_w$. Useful quadratic expectations:

$$\mathbb{E}\|x\|^2 = \operatorname{tr} \Sigma + \| \mu \|^2, \quad \mathbb{E}[x^T A x] = \operatorname{tr}(A \Sigma) + \mu^T A \mu$$

symmetric A .
Sample mean / limit theorems: for independent identically distributed X_i with mean μ , variance σ^2 ,

$$\bar{X}_N = \frac{1}{N} \sum_i X_i, \quad \mathbb{E} \bar{X}_N = \mu, \quad \operatorname{var}(\bar{X}_N) = \frac{\sigma^2}{N}$$

LLN: $\bar{X}_N \rightarrow \mu$. CLT: for large N , $\bar{X}_N \approx \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2/N)$.

Gaussian facts: $X \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$ has density

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(x - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right)$$

About 68%, 95%, 99.7% lies within 1, 2, 3 standard deviations. Standardizing gives $Z = (X - \mu)/\sigma \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$. Affine transformations of jointly Gaussian vectors are jointly Gaussian. For jointly Gaussian variables, zero covariance implies independence.

Multivariate Gaussian: for $\Sigma \succ 0$,

$$f(x) = \frac{\exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(x - \mu)^T \Sigma^{-1}(x - \mu)\right)}{(2\pi)^{n/2} \sqrt{\det \Sigma}}$$

Equal-density contours are covariance ellipsoids. If $z \sim \mathcal{N}(0, I)$, then $x = \mu + \Sigma^{1/2} z \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \Sigma)$.

Gaussian Conditioning / Practice Final

MMSE meaning: among all functions $g(y)$,

$$\hat{x}_{\text{MMSE}}(y) = \mathbb{E}[x | y] = \arg \min_{g(y)} \mathbb{E}[\|x - g(y)\|^2 | y]$$

MAP instead maximizes the posterior density. Posterior mean and mode coincide for a Gaussian.

Joint Gaussian conditioning: if

$$\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} \sim \mathcal{N} \left(\begin{bmatrix} \mu_x \\ \mu_y \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} \Sigma_{xx} & \Sigma_{xy} \\ \Sigma_{yx} & \Sigma_{yy} \end{bmatrix} \right)$$

then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[x | y] &= \mu_x + \Sigma_{xy} \Sigma_{yy}^{-1} (y - \mu_y) \\ \operatorname{Cov}(x | y) &= \Sigma_{xx} - \Sigma_{xy} \Sigma_{yy}^{-1} \Sigma_{yx} \end{aligned}$$

The conditional covariance does not depend on the observed value y . Moreover,

$$\mathbb{E}[\|x - \hat{x}_{\text{MMSE}}\|^2 | y] = \operatorname{tr}(\operatorname{Cov}(x | y))$$

For arbitrary variables with finite second moments, the same mean formula is the best affine estimator; it equals the full MMSE estimator when (x, y) is jointly Gaussian. Its error obeys the orthogonality principle

$$\mathbb{E}[(x - \hat{x})(y - \mu_y)^T] = 0$$

Linear Gaussian model: if

$$x \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \tau^2 I), \quad y = Ax + w, \quad w \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 I), \quad x \perp w$$

$$\operatorname{Cov} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \tau^2 I & \tau^2 A^T \\ \tau^2 A & \tau^2 A A^T + \sigma^2 I \end{bmatrix}$$

and the MMSE estimator is $\hat{x}_{\text{MMSE}} = \tau^2 A^T (\tau^2 A A^T + \sigma^2 I)^{-1} y$

$$\text{Its posterior covariance is } \Sigma_{x|y} = \left(\tau^{-2} I + \sigma^{-2} A^T A \right)^{-1}$$

Along right singular vector v_i , the posterior variance is

$$\operatorname{var}(v_i^T x | y) = \frac{\tau^2 \sigma^2}{\sigma^2 + \tau^2 \sigma_i^2}$$

Measurements reduce uncertainty most in high-gain singular directions.

MMSE equals regularized LS:

$$\hat{x}_{\text{reg}} = (A^T A + \lambda I)^{-1} A^T y, \quad \boxed{\lambda = \sigma^2 / \tau^2}$$

Use $B(I + CB)^{-1} = (I + BC)^{-1} B$ or the push-through identity. More generally, Gaussian $x \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_x, \Sigma_x)$ and $w \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \Sigma_w)$ give both MAP and MMSE as the minimizer of

$$(y - Ax)^T \Sigma_w^{-1} (y - Ax) + (x - \mu_x)^T \Sigma_x^{-1} (x - \mu_x)$$

MMSE shrinkage in SVD: for $A = U \Sigma V^T$,

$$\hat{x}_{\text{MMSE}} = \sum_i \frac{\tau^2 \sigma_i}{\tau^2 \sigma_i^2 + \sigma^2} (u_i^T y) v_i$$

Relative to x_{ls} , component i is multiplied by

$$\gamma_i = \frac{\tau^2 \sigma_i^2}{\tau^2 \sigma_i^2 + \sigma^2} \in (0, 1)$$

Large gain/low noise/weak prior shrinkage gives $\gamma_i \approx 1$;

small gain/high noise/strong small- x prior gives $\gamma_i \approx 0$.

Scalar posterior MSE: for $y = sx + w$ with $s > 0$,

$$\mathbb{E}[(x - \hat{x}_{\text{MMSE}})^2 | y] = \frac{\tau^2 \sigma^2}{\sigma^2 + s^2 \tau^2}$$

It tends to 0 as $\sigma \rightarrow 0$ and to τ^2 as $\sigma \rightarrow \infty$.

Practice Final Problem Patterns

Warehouse stacking: for two warehouses,

$$A_{\text{ship}} = \begin{bmatrix} I & 0 \\ 0 & I \end{bmatrix}, \quad y = \begin{bmatrix} c_1 \\ c_2 \\ c_3 \\ c_4 \end{bmatrix}, \quad A_{\text{pen}} = [I \quad -I]$$

Use $\hat{A} = [A_{\text{ship}}; \sqrt{\mu} A_{\text{pen}}]$, $\hat{y} = [y; 0]$. Uniqueness holds because A_{ship} has full column rank. At $\mu = 0$, each warehouse is its pair's midpoint; as $\mu \rightarrow \infty$, both approach the centroid of all cities. In the practice-final diagonalization, varying μ traces the line segment between these endpoint solutions.

Separate regressions: fitting nonorthogonal feature columns one at a time generally double-counts shared directions and gives a worse residual than joint LS. With orthonormal feature columns U , coefficients decouple:

$$\min_\beta \left\| y - \sum_j \beta_j u_j \right\|^2 \Rightarrow \beta_j = u_j^T y$$

The fitted vector matches joint LS, although coordinates differ from those in the original feature basis.

Rank-deficient regression: zero singular values make $X^T X$ singular. Use $X^\dagger y$; it gives the minimum-norm coefficient among all LS minimizers, while $XX^\dagger y$ is the unique fitted response.

Graph Laplacian: for an undirected weighted graph,

$$L = D - W, \quad x^T L x = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i,j} w_{ij} (x_i - x_j)^2 \geq 0$$

Thus $L \succeq 0$, $L1 = 0$, and the multiplicity of eigenvalue zero equals the number of connected components. The graph is connected iff $\operatorname{null}(L) = \operatorname{span}\{1\}$, equivalently $\lambda_2(L) > 0$.

Decomposition and Model Dictionaries

Which decomposition? QR produces an orthonormal basis for $\operatorname{range}(A)$ plus triangular coordinates; use it for stable solves and LS. EVD exposes invariant modes of a square map and simplifies $A^k, f(A)$, but a full eigenbasis may not exist. Symmetric EVD always has an orthonormal basis; use it for quadratic forms, PSD tests, covariance, and ellipsoid axes. SVD works for every rectangular matrix and exposes gains, rank, four spaces, pseudoinverse, conditioning, and low-rank structure. PCA is not a separate factorization: center the data, then use the symmetric EVD of covariance or SVD of the centered matrix.

Singular-direction filter dictionary: let $s_i > 0$ be a singular value and $d_i = u_i^T y$. The coefficient on v_i is

method	v_i coefficient
pseudoinverse	d_i/s_i
TSVD at k	d_i/s_i ($i \leq k$), 0 ($i > k$)
Tikhonov	$s_i d_i / (s_i^2 + \mu)$
Gaussian MMSE	$\tau^2 s_i d_i / (\tau^2 s_i^2 + \sigma_w^2)$

Relative to direct inversion, the last two shrink by

$$\frac{s_i^2}{s_i^2 + \mu}, \quad \frac{\tau^2 s_i^2}{\tau^2 s_i^2 + \sigma_w^2}$$

Small- s_i modes are precisely where inversion amplifies noise and regularization suppresses it.

Ellipsoid dictionary:

$$\mathcal{E} = \{c + Bz : \|z\| \leq 1\} = \{x : (x - c)^T S (x - c) \leq 1\}, \quad S = (BB^T)^{-1}$$

Axes are the left singular vectors of B , with lengths $\sigma_i(B)$. For the covariance ellipsoid $(x - c)^T \Sigma^{-1} (x - c) \leq \alpha$, one may take

$$B = \sqrt{\alpha} \Sigma^{1/2}, \quad S = \alpha^{-1} \Sigma^{-1}$$

Thus PCA eigenvectors give the axes, covariance eigenvalues give squared standard deviations, and Mahalanobis distance measures radius in these standardized coordinates.

Four-space projector dictionary: for thin $A = U_r \Sigma_r V_r^T$,

$\operatorname{range}(A)$	$AA^\dagger = U_r U_r^T$
$\operatorname{null}(A^T)$	$I - AA^\dagger = I - U_r U_r^T$
$\operatorname{range}(A^T)$	$A^\dagger A = V_r V_r^T$
$\operatorname{null}(A)$	$I - A^\dagger A = I - V_r V_r^T$

$$\text{Hence } \min_x \|Ax - y\| = \|(I - AA^\dagger)y\|, \quad \hat{y} = AA^\dagger y$$

$$\text{Also } (A^\dagger)^T = (A^T)^\dagger, \quad \|A^\dagger\| = \frac{1}{\sigma_r}$$

where σ_r is the smallest positive singular value.

Closest-point proof: verify $p \in S$ and $e = y - p \in S^\perp$. For every $z \in S$, Pythagoras gives

$$\|y - z\|^2 = \|e + (p - z)\|^2 = \|e\|^2 + \|p - z\|^2 \geq \|e\|^2$$

so p is uniquely closest. For an affine set, $P_{x_0+S}(y) = x_0 + P_S(y - x_0)$.

Singular-value perturbation: $|\sigma_i(A + E) - \sigma_i(A)| \leq \|E\|$

Normal-equation conditioning:

$$\lambda_i(A^T A) = \sigma_i(A)^2, \quad \kappa(A^T A) = \kappa(A)^2$$

for full-column-rank A . Normal equations square conditioning and can lose about twice as many digits; prefer QR or SVD numerically.